Summary

In natural environments microogranisms exist as mixed cultures. Survival and growth of microorganisms depends upon the availability of favourable growth environment. Cultivation of microorganisms in the laboratory plays an important role in isolation, identification and classification of microorganisms. A medium is an environment which supplies the nutrients necessary for the growth of the microorganisms. Various kinds of media have been prepared to satisfy the need of the microorganism to be isolated as a pure culture. Based on the physical, chemical and special purposes, media are classified and are used to identify a particular organism from a clinical specimen or environment. In Microbiology there are many methods used for isolation of microorganisms. The methods commonly used for isolation are pour plate, spread plate method and streak plate method.

The growth of organisms on media is a basic criteria in the isolation, identification, and classification of microorganisms. Colony characterization of both bacteria and fungi highly depends upon the nutrients, temperature and pH.

Evaluation

Multiple choice questions

1. In a culture, the desired organism is low in number when compared with unwanted microorganism. Which media can be used to isolate the desired organism?
   a. Selective media
   b. Enriched media
   c. Basal media
   d. General purpose media
2. _____ is an example for differential media
   a. Blood agar
   b. EMB agar
   c. Both a and b
   d. None
3. A medium in which precise ingredients are clearly defined.
   a. Synthetic medium.
   b. Non synthetic medium.
   c. Complex medium
   d. Natural medium
4. A microbial inoculum of faecal specimen is subjected to isolation of typhoid bacilli species. Which medium can be used to select the bacilli?
   a. Selective medium
   b. Basal medium
   c. Enriched medium
   d. Differential medium
5. _____ is the method in which inoculum is not placed over the surface of agar plate.
   a. Pour plate method
   b. Spread plate method
   c. Streak plate method
   d. All the above
6. Name the method in which the inoculums is mixed with the molten agar medium in the test tube and poured into the sterile petridish
   a. Pour plate method
   b. Spread plate method
   c. Streak plate
   d. All the above

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